HACKACHUSETTS · CIVIC ACTION TRACK

Mapachusetts

Politics, mapped to where you live. An interactive 3D globe that shows every layer of government covering a spot, plus the races and candidates that matter there.

Built with Kiro

THE PROBLEM

Where you live decides who represents you. That is hard to see.

- One address can sit in a congressional district, a state senate district, a state house district, a county, a town, a school district and a ward.
  Each layer has its own officials and its own races.
- Voters rarely see all of those layers in one place.
- Good, cited information about candidates is scattered across news sites and campaign pages.

THE SOLUTION

Pick a place on a globe. See the whole stack.

- Find a place four ways: **search**, **Use my location**, **browse menus** (State, County, City), or **click the globe**.
- A **layer dock** of color-coded chips, each with a glowing outline on the map.
- **Ballot by layer**: what each level of government does and the races it decides.
- An **Events** tab for town halls and meetings, and an Election Day countdown.

CANDIDATE RESEARCH

Click a candidate. Get a cited, six-tab profile.

Six tabs

- In the News (cited)
- Funding
- Career
- Issues, with voting records
- Sources
- Myths & Facts

Real Massachusetts 2026 races

- Governor: Maura Healey, Mike Minogue
- U.S. Senate: Ed Markey, John Deaton
- Every profile has a shareable link

Built to be checked

- News summaries carry numbered citations
- Citations are validated when the data is built
- Only headlines, links, snippets and summaries are stored

LIVE DEMO

What we will show

1. Open the globe and drill into Massachusetts.
2. Search an address. Watch the layer stack appear.
3. Click a layer chip to highlight its boundary.
4. Open the governor race and a candidate profile.
5. Read the cited news and check a source.

HOW IT WORKS

Real boundaries, real research, one data seam.

Globe app

- MapLibre 3D globe, OpenFreeMap basemaps
- U.S. Census TIGERweb for districts, counties, towns and precincts
- Ward data for Boston, Chicago and NYC
- Photon geocoder for search
- No API keys needed

Research app

- Next.js (App Router) and Supabase
- RSS news ingest into Supabase
- Claude-written summaries with checked citations
- Built for Vercel and Supabase hosting

One source of truth

- Candidate data lives in the research app
- A script exports it for the globe
- Both apps show the same candidates

WHAT IS REAL, AND WHAT IS NOT

We label our data honestly.

- **Real:** Census boundaries, and the Massachusetts 2026 governor and U.S. Senate races.
- **Sample:** other states' races, local offices and events. They are labeled "Sample" in the app.
- **U.S. only** for now. Everything else on the globe is greyed out.
- Districts and precincts can lag reality, so the app tells people to confirm with their local election office.

BUILT WITH KIRO

Four teammates, three Kiro tools, one app.

Tools

- Kiro IDE
- Kiro CLI
- Kiro Web

What Kiro did

- Built the 3D globe, then refined it
- Scaffolded the Next.js and Supabase app and the cited news pipeline
- Merged teammate branches into one app
- Flagged an exposed key; secrets moved out of git

In the repo (.kiro)

- Steering: product, tech, data rules
- Hook: re-export candidate data on save

TEAM AND WHAT IS NEXT

Mapachusetts team

Rayna (wrayna) · Priscila Machado · Senny Lu (Wixisiz) · Shamus Duffey

- Real races beyond Massachusetts, and real local offices and events.
- Read Supabase live in the globe instead of an exported file.
- More cities with ward and council-district data.
- U.S. territories, and automated tests.